K J Somaiya Institute of Management
Branding Policy

Preamble

The Brand Guidelines have been formulated for the Somaiya Vidyavihar University and its constituent institutes including K J Somaiya Institute of Management. The guidelines are applicable to Somaiya Vidyavihar University and its constituent institutes.

This branding policy is to establish guidelines for maintaining a consistent, professional, and recognizable brand identity for K J Somaiya Institute of Management (KJSIM) and coherence with Somaiya Vidyavihar University. This policy ensures that all communication, marketing, branding, and promotional activities align with the institute's purpose, vision, mission, values, and strategic goals. Defining elements like brand element (the edge), logo, colour palette, typography, and brand voice creates a unified and coherent brand image across various platforms.

Scope

This policy applies to all KJSIM stakeholders, including faculty, staff, students, and external partners (for co-branding) involved in creating or disseminating content that represents the institute.

a) **Marketing and Promotional Materials**

- All marketing collateral, including but not limited to brochures, posters, banners, and advertisements, must adhere to branding guidelines and be approved by the MarCom & PR Team.
- Collaborations with external agencies for marketing must ensure compliance with KJSIM's branding policy.
- Branded merchandise, such as apparel, stationery, and souvenirs, must comply with the branding guidelines.
- Event branding, including backdrops, stage design, and promotional materials, must align with KJSIM's identity.

b) **Digital Presence**

- **Website**: Content on the KJSIM website must align with branding guidelines and be approved by the designated authority.
- **Social Media**: All official KJSIM social media accounts must follow the branding guidelines. Posts should reflect the institute's purpose, vision, mission and values, avoiding controversial or sensitive topics.
- **Email Communication**: Use official email signatures and refrain from using personal accounts for official correspondence.

The specifics of branding guidelines are covered as a part of the ready reckoner (Annexure 1).

Compliance and Review

All areas and student bodies are responsible for adhering to this policy and ensuring compliance. Periodic reviews of the branding policy will be conducted to align with evolving industry standards.

Reporting and Approvals

Any deviations from the branding guidelines must be reported to the Marketing Communications team for review and approval. The Head of MarCom will have the final authority on branding-related matters.

For student bodies, not all posts need to be approved by the MarCom & PR Committee, the committees/clubs/bodies can get templates approved beforehand and change the content as per their needs.
The steps to get templates verified are as follows:

- Make templates according to the brand guidelines
- Whatsapp them on the official Branding POC groups or email them to pr.simsr@somaiya.edu
- Student bodies are requested to get their templates verified well in advance
- The MarCom & PR Team will respond within 24 working hours depending on the quantum and nature of creative(s).

Enforcement

The brand guidelines came into effect on 1st July 2020 for all forms of communication, and it is mandatory for all stakeholders to adhere to them. The faculty in charge and the students' steering team of the respective student body should ensure that the brand guidelines are followed thoroughly as they are responsible for the same. Inconsistent use of brand elements can dilute the Institute's identity and ultimately undermine its efforts to establish a strong brand presence. Non-compliance with the branding policy may result in corrective measures, including the removal of unapproved materials and revoking digital assets. Refer to the brand regulation framework attached as Annexure 2.

This branding policy ensures that KJSIM maintains a strong, cohesive, and professional identity across all touchpoints, reinforcing its reputation as a leading business school.

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Annexure 1: Brand Guidelines Ready Reckoner

Brand Driver Platform – For Somaiya Vidyavihar University

Why do we exist?

To provide unfettered access to learnings and experiences, that enable each individual to build their skills and capabilities, acquiring the readiness to create their future.

- Distinguished Beliefs
  - Sky's the limit
  - Rooted in values
  - Challenging the norm is key
  - Each person has a unique potential
  - We are stronger together
- Brand Idea
  - Freedom of Possibilities
- Brand Persona
  - The Favourite Teacher
- Behaviours
  - Courageous
  - Imaginative
  - Open
  - Nurturing
- Brand Voice Principles
  - Inspiring
  - Bold
  - Empowering
  - Optimistic

Purpose – For K J Somaiya Institute of Management

Transforming, Together

Together we enable the transformation journeys of individuals to value-based and purpose-driven leaders for building a better world.

Institute Name

The institute name should always be written as **K J Somaiya Institute of Management.** For internal communication with Somaiya Vidyavihar University, nomenclature of **Faculty of Management Studies** shall be used.

Dos

- Leave space between K and J
- KJSIM acronym can be used in official documents, emails, and social media platforms

Don’ts

- Usage of a dot (.) between K and J

Brand Asset

Logo

- It consists of an emblem and a wordmark (Somaiya Vidyavihar University Logo)
- Emblem - Represents the drive and flame the University ignites within every student
- Institute Logo - The Institute name will appear below the University name, building a consistent hierarchy within the brand
- Note - The logo that is snipped out from various posts has K.J. but the approved logo does not have dots (.) between these, so avoid using it
- Avoid using the Somaiya Vidyavihar University logo anywhere (print or digital), instead use the new institute logo which has the University as a part of it
- AACSB Accredited logo mandatory for offline academic designs and online marketing collaterals (like brochure, newsletter, etc) and not mandatory for social media posts
- Refrain from using the AACSB Member logo anywhere
- Somaiya Trust Logo - The Somaiya Trust Logo can only be used for corporate communication, especially for University communication. Avoid usage on social media, google ads, brochures, flyers, and emailers
- The Institute's logo should be bigger than or equal to any other logo/wordmark present in the creative (including sponsor logos), apart from sponsor announcements and non-promotional brand campaign posts
- Student committees/clubs/bodies logos have been discontinued since Sept 2020, hence should be avoided in all design collaterals, only the committees/clubs/bodies wordmark may be used
- Logos of certain flagship events, such as Samavaya, ICON, Melange, Superstars, etc. have been allowed to be retained.

Logo Background

Dos

- The Power Red Logo is permitted with a white background only
- The Black and White Logos may be placed on any coloured backgrounds

Don'ts

- Tilting the logo, distorting it, or overlaying it is inadvisable
- Avoid applying effects to the Logo, no shadows, gradient background, or outline

Placement of the logo

- It should only be placed in any of the four corners, provided it is NOT on a photographic background or overlapping with 'The Edge'
- A clear space of 1x on all four sides of the logo is advised. (The 'S' height of the Somaiya wordmark equals 'x'). Refer to examples 1 & 2.
- Only for certificates, the logo can be placed in the top centre of the page

Example 1: Logo Opposite to the edge

Example 2: Logo Above the Edge

Brand Colours

Primary Colours		
Colour	Colour code (HEX)	Colour code (PANTONE)
Power Red	#b7202e	186 C
Vitality red	#ed1c24	2347 C
Cool Gray	#58595b	Cool Gray 10 C
Light Black	#231f20	-
Pure White	#ffffff	-
Note: The colour black is light black (#231f20) and **not** pure black (#000000)		

Secondary Colours (To be used only for borders, elements, infographics & graphs in PPT, flyers, etc.)	
Colour Code	Colour Code
#f58220	#a25723
#ffcb05	#603312

Typography

Primary font – Marcellus

- To be used for Heading & Subheading
- For PPT: For Heading, Subheading
- Click to download font

Secondary font - Fira Sans (Light, Regular, Medium, and Bold)

- Fira Sans – To be used for Body & Action copy
- For PPT: Body & Action only
- Click to download font

System font – Arial

- For Internal Communication and PPT (if primary & secondary font is not available)

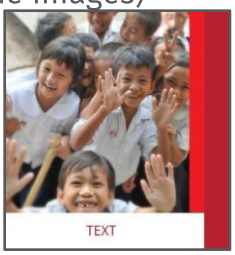
Text Colours

- Font colours allowed for any text - Power Red, Cool Gray, and Pure White. For brochures, presentations, and videos, black font is also allowed.
- Usage of Pure White text can only be on Power Red and Cool Grey backgrounds.

Brand Element – The Edge

- This Brand Element represents our Edge over the other Institutes
- Edge comprises of 2 colours - Power Red which should constitute minimum of 80% of the edge and Vitality red in the range of 5% to 20% proportion to that of the brand's Power Red
- The Edge should always form an 'L' shaped design – normal/inverted/flipped/others
- Power red should form an 'L' shape, and vitality red will be a horizontal extension to power red
- The L shaped design of the edge should be formed by Power Red and Vitality Red should just be an extension of it (Refer to the images)

(Correct)



(Incorrect)

- The size of the Vitality Red in the Edge should be equal to the size of the image if the white space is not extended to the other side
- Border of images can only be in Cool Grey, Power Red or secondary colours
- No text should touch the Edge
- Overlapping of images/elements with the Edge is not allowed
- The whole edge should be on top of the image unless it is used as an extension

Incorrect

Correct

Correct

Note: No text-heavy image is allowed for these types of creatives

Email IDs

- All the email IDs that have SIMSR in them can be retained
- Profile pictures of the email accounts should be changed to committees/clubs/bodies wordmarks shared with them
- Committees/clubs/bodies logos are no longer permissible to be used

Social Media Handles of Committee/Club/Student Body Pages

- The profile picture of the account should be of committees/clubs/bodies wordmark as shared here
- The name of the handle should be - Committee/Club/Body name - Institute name, e.g.: Finstreet - K J Somaiya Institute of Management
- For committee/club/body Instagram account, the official page of the institute is to be tagged in the bio (example: R.E.A.D Club – Literature Club @kjsim.official)
- In case of character limitation and other restrictions, the handle names can be committee/clubs/body name - KJSIM
- LinkedIn and Facebook cover should follow the branding guidelines
- Avoid using logos (University, Somaiya Trust, Committee/Club/Body logo) on creatives posted on social media handles.

Digital Creatives & Templates

Dos

- Always use 'The Edge' in digital posters
- There should only be one Edge in a single creative
- The Edge should be visible from the grid view itself
- In a social media carousel post, brochure, flyer, newsletter or magazine, the first page must have an Edge
- The pictures/photographs used in the creatives should preferably be in either rectangular, square, or linear form, avoid curved edges or layout
- Multiple images can be used with proper tags (description of the image)
- The borders touching images should either be square/rectangular. Linear shapes can be allowed. Refer to the examples below
- Picture collages should have space between them- preferably white

Allowed

Not Allowed

Allowed

Allowed

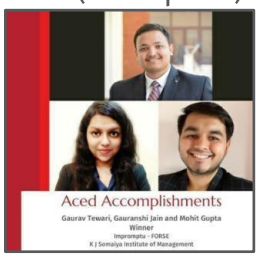
Don'ts

- Fonts cannot be used in italics weights
- Text-heavy elements are to be avoided
- Refer to the examples below of incorrect cases:

- Textual images will require borders
- Pictures of speakers/guests cannot have circular or different-shaped borders and they should preferably be square or rectangular

- Virtual meet screenshots are allowed (Example 3)

Example 1: Not Allowed

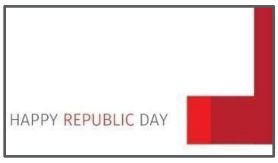


Example 2: Allowed

Example 3: Allowed

- Usage of hanging edges is allowed ONLY for brochures & magazines, not for social media creatives:
  The vertex of the edge should be on one of the four corners of the creative. In other words, the Vitality Red part of the Edge should necessarily touch the top or bottom wall of the creative.

Allowed



Not Allowed

Not Allowed (Social media)

Only for Videos

- Power Red and Cool Gray font colours are permitted only on white backgrounds
- White and black font colour is permitted on any background colour
- First frame of the video/reel should have an Edge

Only for Presentations

- Power Red and Cool Gray font colours are permitted only on white backgrounds
- Usage of white and black font colours is allowed
- Usage of non-linear borders around text for infographics is allowed
- Picture collage is allowed
- Overlap of text of any kind on the Edge to be avoided
- Refer to the official template sent to everyone via email

Only for Magazines, Reports, Newsletters, Brochures

- Usage of non-rectangular shapes is allowed
- Usage of italics is allowed for disclaimers
- Bold font is allowed for body text as well
- Magazines and newsletters are allowed to have logos for social media

Social Media Stories

- It is mandatory to use the Edge in the first story of a series (including reshared stories) of social media stories posted within 24 hours
- Resharing a post is allowed without using an edge
- Using Instagram font is allowed only for live event coverage (excluding announcements, informational stories, etc)

Emailers

- The font style should preferably be Arial (internal communication) Marcellus & Fira Sans (external communication)
- Random font colours should be avoided
- Creatives in emails can have the institute logo and student body name (if required)

- The first creative in every email should have an edge

Merchandise Guidelines

- K J Somaiya Institute of Management logo (KJSIM logo) must be used, exceptions can be considered subject to prior approval
- Student body logos/insignias/crests etc are not allowed, only wordmarks are allowed
- The fonts should be Fira Sans or Marcellus
- The font colours Power Red/Cool Grey/Black/White are to be used
- The base colour of the merchandise can be as per the student body's choice

Photography

- Black and white photography is to be avoided.

Co-Branding

- Co-Branding refers to any scenario wherein a committee/club/student body is part of an organisation or is collaborating with an external organisation for a specific activity
- Committees/Clubs/Bodies that use Co-Branding should use the common colours between the Branding Guidelines and their respective Brands
- Logo of any other brand used in the creatives cannot be bigger than the Institute logo
- In cases where sponsors require specific digital deliverables aligned with their branding guidelines, student bodies must share the relevant documents or communications with PoCs for review
- It is mandatory for the brand to accept the collaboration request. Only in such scenarios, and for a limited number of posts, exceptions to the branding guidelines can be considered.

FAQs

Q. What about templates for certificates?
A. Certificates will be generated via the in-house software. Only textual content and other elements need to be shared by the student body's faculty head. Link: Digital Certificates

Q. What about the video content, Do the brand guidelines need to be followed?
A. Yes, brand guidelines need to be followed i.e., have 'the edge' as a video template and if there is some written content then the typography should be according to the guidelines. The first frame should necessarily have 'The Edge' on it. This can be the case for informative videos or videos on social media.
Note: Though the edge is only compulsory in the first frame of the video, all the other specifications such as font, text, colour, etc. should be in accordance with the guidelines.

Q. In a continuous flow (in the case of a PDF of a brochure with multiple pages) the edges cannot be on the same side or be one below another?
A. When there are multiple pages in a PDF, and it rolls in one after the other as a page view, the Edge cannot be on the same side as it conflicts with the reading flow. So, for aesthetic purposes and to guide the movement of the eye, it is recommended not to use the Edge on the right side or the left side on two consecutive pages.

(Incorrect)

Logos to be used only when printing or using it on third-party apps/websites like Unstop /WhatsApp/Google ads, etc)

S.No	Platform	KJSIM Logo to be used	Typesetting (Heading)	Typesetting (Body copy/Subheading)	Size of the creative
Digital Applications					
1)	Emailer	Yes	Sentence case - Font: Marcellus Regular 32 pt	Body copy - Sentence case - Font: Fira Sans Regular 10 pt by 12 pt leading	600 px (W)
2)	Digital (Facebook)	No	Sentence case - Font: Marcellus Regular 39.3 pt	Subheading - Sentence case - Font: Marcellus Regular 41.3 pt	1200 px (w) x 717 px (h)
3)	Digital (Instagram)	No	Sentence case - Font: Marcellus Regular 79pt by 84 pt leading	Subheading - Sentence case - Font: Marcellus Regular 50.7 pt Hashtags - Use Uppercase. Font: Marcellus Regular 50.7 pt	1080 px (w) x 1080 px (h)
Print Applications					
1)	Certificates	Yes	Presentation Line: Marcellus Regular 18-22 points (Sentence case) Recipient's Name: Marcellus Regular 26 points (Title case) Description: Marcellus Regular 18-22 points (Sentence case) Authorised Signatory: Marcellus Regular 15 points (Title case)		
2)	Brochure (Cover Page)	Yes	Sentence case – Marcellus Regular 57 point	Year: Marcellus Regular 17.4 point (Upper Case) Website: Fira Sans Medium 15 point Content: Marcellus Regular 30 point Content Details: Fira sans regular 14-30.4 point (All sentence case)	
3)	Brochure (Inside Page)	No	Photo Caption: Marcellus Regular 27 points (Title case) Year: Marcellus Regular 16.6 points Heading 1: Marcellus Regular 26 point (Sentence case)	Body copy: Fira Sans regular 10- 12 point Highlight 1: Fira Sans bold 10-12 point Highlight 2: Fira Sans regular 13-15.6 point Heading 2: Marcellus Regular 29.2 point (All sentence case)	210 mm (w) x 297 mm (h) (Close size)
Note - The sizes of the creatives mentioned above are only indicative. It can use different sizes according to convenience/requirement/aesthetics					

Ready Reckoner for the usage of logos

Design	Institute Logo (any corner)	Somaiya Trust Logo	Committee/ Club/ Student Body Logo	Committee/ Club/Student Body wordmark	Brand Element (Edge)	AACSB Accredited logo
Social Media Post	O	×	×	O	✓	O
Digital Ads on owned media	✓	×	×	O	✓	O
Newsletters/ Magazines/ Brochures	✓	×	×	O	✓	✓
Third-party platforms (Whatsapp, Unstop, Pagalguy, etc.)	✓	×	×	O	✓	O
Printed (Banners, Posters, standee)	✓	×	×	O	✓	✓
Emails	O	×	×	O	✓	O
Certificates	✓	✓	×	O	✓	✓
PPTs (Somaiya Trust Logo to be only used on the title slide)	✓	✓	×	O	✓	✓
✓ - Mandatory | × - Not Required | O – Optional						

Annexure 2: Brand Regulation Framework

The Brand Regulation Framework states the consequences of non-compliance to brand guidelines. This framework is essential to ensure that all the student bodies of KJSIM follow the branding guidelines so that the Institute's brand remains coherent, respected, and influential in all its communications and representations.

- The student bodies will be **notified** of minor first-time errors
- A **warning** will be issued if the mistake is repeated, or another significant error occurs
- A **strike** will be given on persistent violations and non-compliance with previous warnings
- Third Strike will lead to **Faculty Escalation** and can result in **Suspension** of all forms of communication (printed, digital, merchandise etc)
- Any form of communication can be **taken down** at any of these above stages

Suspension of Communication:

- Communication can be suspended anytime, including **ongoing events** of the student bodies
- The suspension period will be **10 days or more**, depending on the severity of the violation

Undertaking

I, _____, on behalf of the, _____ (student body), hereby affirm our commitment to adhere to Brand Guidelines and Policy set forth by **K J Somaiya Institute of Management.**

We acknowledge that these guidelines and policies are essential in maintaining the Institute's reputation, integrity, and cohesive identity, and ensuring consistent communication across all platforms and events associated with the Institute.

Name and Signature
Student Steering Member

Name and Signature
Faculty